
GUILD
DUMRAKHAL
The Silk Infestation
HOMEBREW
Communications with the mountain fortress of Dumrakhal have ceased. Every hero and scout sent to investigate has failed to return. Will your party answer the call before the city is lost?

# DUMRAKHAL

## The Silk Infestation



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# INTRODUCTION AND SETUP

For centuries, the mountain fortress of Dumrakhal stood as a monument to dwarven pride and industry. After a devastating war, the city was abandoned for generations. But in recent years, brave dwarves returned to reclaim their ancestral home. They opened the sealed gate, repaired the legendary forge, and restarted production. This new trading route brought prosperity to nearby settlements. But today, the grand halls are quiet once again.

Communication with Dumrakhal has ceased completely, and every scout sent into the dwarven city has not returned. One thing is clear: if Dumrakhal falls, hundreds of families who depend on its trade will face ruin. But even worse, what dark power is now nesting deep inside the mountain?

> "We cleared the halls and rebuilt our forge *stone by stone. We thought the danger was past. We never knew the stone beneath us held a nest of monsters."*
>
> — Thrum Heavy-Hand, *Master Smith of Dumrakhal*

## Overview and Background

An alien infestation has taken over the dwarven city of Dumrakhal. They have enslaved the dwarven workers and are preparing to conquer the region.

The crisis began a few weeks ago when dwarven miners tried to reopen a mining vein that was sealed off by a past collapse. They did not know that this tunnel went all the way down into the underdark, home of a Neogi colony.

The Neogi are evil alien slavers that look like giant spiders with an eel's head. Led by a ruthless leader named Vrax the Silk-Tyrant, the Neogi poured out of the tunnel and attacked the city. Using dark mind-control magic, they captured the dwarves warriors and turned the remaining ones into slaves.

Today, Dumrakhal is a dark prison filled with webs and iron cages. The Neogi are tearing down the beautiful dwarven stone walls to build their own alien nest. A few brave survivors are hiding in secret rooms, trying to help the captives and recover their home.

## Plot Hooks

- A wealthy armor and weapon store owner in a nearby human city is losing a lot of money because trade with Dumrakhal has stopped. He offers the party a large gold reward if they go into the mountain, find out what happened to his dwarven suppliers, and return with news or safe trading contracts.
- The party hears rumors of Thrum Heavy-Hand, a legendary dwarven blacksmith in Dumrakhal who can forge extraordinary weapons and armor. However, Thrum has not sent any new metalwork out of the city for weeks. A martial character or someone looking for powerful magic items decides to go to Dumrakhal directly to seek his legendary craft.
- A party member suffers from a strange curse, disease, or poison that normal magic cannot cure, or they need rare knowledge about the region's history. Local villagers tell them about Galgadayle Coppersong, a gentle firbolg cleric who settled in Dumrakhal. He is the only healer nearby strong enough to cure them or answer their questions.
- A loved NPC approaches the party with tears in their eyes. Their brother, a brave young scout, went to Dumrakhal two weeks ago to check on the city and never came back. They offer the party everything they have, a family treasure, if they can find him and bring him back alive.

## NPC Reference Table

Quick reference for major NPCs present in this adventure:

| Name | Role | Key Connection |
|---|---|---|
| **Thrum Heavy-Hand** | Dwarf Blacksmith | Leads the dwarf resistance; offers blacksmithing services |
| **Galgadayle Coppersong** | Firbolg Cleric | Rescues survivors; offers healing services and information |
| **Vrax** | Neogi Leader | Controls the halls and enslaves the miners |

# Using this adventure

General description

## Structure

Lazy dm explanation how the clues work how the strong start and the finale mean. Explain how the NPC, monsters and the items are meant to be printed as handouts.

- Explain the clue system
- Explain the stron start to get the players in game fast
- Explain the great finale and the plot twist
- Explain about the location methodology:
    - description method used by the youtuver where a general description gives X interest points that the players can interact with to get more information about them.Characteristics are here
    - Fantasti details: make the world more magical and it is telling a sotry
    - Encounter: Description of the encounter. (Describe the encounter type. Puzzle description, monster tactics, NPC interactions)
    - Tresure: What can be found (can be items, help, money, information, etc)

### Encounters

Combat Encounters

6tjmEncounters where the party fights one or more opponents, requiring dice rolls for attacks, spells, and saving throws. Common combat styles include: • Skirmish: Standard, frequent tactical fights against small or medium groups of foes. • Ambush: Sudden attacks where the party or enemies are caught off-guard or flat-footed. • Targeted Strike: A high-control, strategic mission to take out a specific high-value target. • Horde: Large-scale battles against massive numbers of weak minions (like dozens of goblins) focused on resource management. • Elite Team: A small group of named, powerful villains with distinct classes, teamwork, and legendary traits. • Stomping Ground: Combat heavily defined by a unique, interactive, or hazardous environment. • Boss Battle: A dramatic, high-stakes showdown against a primary antagonist or monster. • Puzzle Combat: A fight where brute force isn't enough; players must interact with the room mechanics to win. Combat difficulty is officially scaled into four tiers in the D&D Basic Rules: Easy, Medium, Hard, and Deadly.

2. Social Interaction Encounters

Encounters built around dialogue, roleplaying, and negotiation with non-player characters (NPCs) rather than drawing swords. • Negotiation & Bribes: Convincing a guard, merchant, or rival to change their mind. • Information Gathering: Extracting clues, lore, or directions through persuasion, deception, or intimidation. • Potential Combat: Tense face-offs where enemies or strangers open with dialogue before deciding whether to fight.

3. Exploration Encounters

Encounters focused on problem-solving, environmental hazards, and discovery. • Traps & Hazards: Physical or magical obstacles that drain time, health, or resources (such as pits, gas, or cursed wards). • Puzzles & Riddles: Mental challenges required to open doors, bypass seals, or unlock ancient secrets. • Mystery & Investigation: Tracking footprints, researching enemy patrol schedules, or piecing together clues.

## Resources

List of all files like maps

## Scaling the adventure

Explain methods to scale them

## As a one shot

Explain how it fits a one shot idea

## As part of your campaign

Explain how could be adapted in a wider campaing

## As part of the sandbox

Explain how it fits in the location

# THE ADVENTURE

DUMRAKHAL IS AN OPEN-CHOICE DUNGEON CRAWL. A Neogi colony, led by **Vrax the Silk-Master**, has invaded an ancient dwarven mine through an opened Underdark vein. They have enslaved the dwarven miners and taken control over the main halls. The heroes must enter the infested halls, find allies, free the captive workers, and seal the Underdark breach before the Neogi attack the region.



## Setting

### Possible adventure flow

The adventure begins at the main gates of Dumrakhal. The heavy stone doors are sealed shut, and the party must solve an ancient dwarven puzzle or find a side entrance to get inside. Once past the doors, the heroes step into a grand entry hall choked with thick silver silk, giving the illusion of a spider lair. Here, they are ambushed by mind-controlled dwarven guards. The party must decide whether to kill these guards or knock them unconscious to spare their lives.

From the entry hall, the heroes can choose two different paths to find help. Taking the forge path leads them to **Thrum Heavy-Hand**, who offers armor upgrades and weapons. Taking the grotto path leads them to **Galgadayle Coppersong**, who provides useful salves. Both allies explain the true nature of the Neogi infestation and can join the party as a sidekick to help guide them through the dangerous mines.

Next, the party must cross the Great Nest, a massive chamber filled with hanging silk cocoons holding the missing scouts. During their exploration, a cocoon bursts open and unleashes hungry Neogi hatchlings. As the party fights these younger monsters, adult Neogi arrive alongside an enslaved Umber Hulk. The adult Neogi use their mind-control powers on the heroes, showing the party the true danger of these alien slavers.

Finally, the party reaches the deep mines where dwarven workers and their families are held in hanging cages. To complete their mission, the heroes can incite a full dwarven prison revolt, or use the secret passage to sneak directly to The High Junction. There the party have access to the reopened mine vein, and they face **Vrax the Silk-Master**. The party can defeat Vrax, negotiate a tense trade deal, or detonate blasting powder to permanently seal the tunnel and save the city.

### Secrets and Clues

These secrets and clues are not locked behind specific rooms or skill checks. Reveal them whenever characters investigate an area, interrogate enemies, talk to allies, or pass a skill check. Depending on your party's choices and actions, you can reveal none, a few, or all of these secrets during the adventure.

- **Sealing the breach:** The Neogi enter through the reopened mine vein. A box of dwarven blasting powder near the mine tracks can be detonated inside the tunnel to collapse the passage and stop Neogi reinforcements.

- **The scout's map:** A dead scout carries a rough map marking two deadly Neogi web traps in the main corridors.
- **Healing medicine:** Rare glowing mushrooms in the grotto can be made into a special cream. This medicine cures the Neogi's bite, removes the poisoned condition, and grants poison resistance.
- **Neogi fear fire:** Neogi webs burn instantly. Vrax and his colony fear fire because large flames destroy their silk. Near large fires, Neogi lose their *Mental Fortitude*.
- **A safe haven:** Thrum's forge serves as a safe rest area. The Neogi avoid this room due to the intense heat and fire.
- **Umber Hulks are mind slaves:** Umber Hulks do not serve the Neogi willingly. If the Neogi controlling an Umber Hulk is killed or knocked unconscious, the beast will break free and escape into the wild.
- **The secret knock:** Captive dwarves tap three times ( `tap-tap... tap` ) with their handcuffs. Hearing this means prisoners are ready to revolt if freed.
- **The crystal keys:** TThe Neogi do not use metal keys for their hanging cages. Instead, they use small dark magic crystals. The chief Neogi overseer carries these crystal key tokens.
- **The secret passage:** A hidden passage connects the Great Nest directly to The High Junction.

## Environmental conditions

- Thick Webbing: The webs hanging between pillars create difficult terrain in specific 10-foot patches marked on the map. A creature entering a webbed area for the first time on a turn or starting its turn there must succeed on a DC 12 Dexterity saving throw or become restrained by the webs. The webs can be destroyed by fire (AC 10, 10 HP, vulnerability to fire damage).

## Extra

- Door Puzzle
- Attack of the dwarves (4 dwarves mind controlled)
- The forge (some dwarfs resist here)
- The shrine (A firbolg is secretly saving some)
- The great hall (first encounter with the coocoons and the neogi and umber hulk)
- The lab (here they see enslaved dwarves and the reproduction process)

# Act I: The dwarf riddle

### Arriving to Dumrakhal

The cold mountain wind batters your body through your armor, carrying the scent of wet stone, pine and snow. Every step echoes in the silence of this pass. You stand at the base of a snow-capped mountain range. Towering 20 feet above you, two giant dwarven statues guard a robust door with their stone warhammers.

The pass inside the mountain is sealed by a double door made of solid black adamantine, bound in thick bronze. Forged to resist dragon fire and heavy siege engines, brute force will not scratch it. The entrance is framed by two stone arches that seem to come from different ages. Each arch has inscriptions carved into the stone.

It seems that unlocking this entrance is the only way to make your way into Dumrakhal.

### Characteristics

The following characteristics can be given by inspecting the location or succeeding an ability check. –//MOVE THIS TO THE EXPLANATION SECTION//–

- **The arches:** The outer arch has an inscription detailing local lore, while the inner arch contains the encrypted message needed to open the door.

The adamantine doors are framed by two arches. The outer arch, built from black basalt, has a dwarvish inscription carved into it:

*"From our vaults flow untarnished treasures and masterwork crafts to the valleys. In turn, trade sustains our fires. Together, mountain and valley thrive as one."*

Just inside, an older arch made of rough grey granite sits deeper toward the door. A long string of dwarven runes is engraved across it, a faint light pulsing softly from within them.

Present the rune sequence to the party. The secret message can be chosen from Appendix C: Puzzle Handout, or tailored to fit your campaign theme. To show how the puzzle works, the example sequence below translates to "WE ARE FRIENDS".

ᛎ· Σ:  ᚠ· ᚳ: Σ:
Σ: ᚳ: ᚢ: Σ: ᚹ: Σ· ᚳ:

- **The dwarf statues:** They hold some history for this place and the code to decipher the puzzle.

Two colossal dwarven warriors stand proudly on either side of the gate, guarding the entrance with their massive warhammers. The statues rest on pedestals carved from the mountain's bedrock. Upon clearing away the dust, a common inscription can be read:

*"In memory of the Battlehammer brothers, who gave their lives to hold the pass against the hill giants while the portal of Dumrakhal was forged."*

Behind the pedestal the party can find the following code:

### Rune code

| A,B,C | D,E,F | G,H,I | J,K,L |
|---|---|---|---|
| ᚠ | Σ | ᚢ | ᚹ |

| M,N,O | P,Q,R,S | T,U,V | W,X,Y,Z |
|---|---|---|---|
| ᚹ | ᚳ | X | ᛎ |



### Fantastic Details

- **Anti-giant door:** The adamantine door contains a dormant abjuration aura designed specifically to push away huge creatures like giants.
- **Starlight sensitivity:** The soft pulse of the runes grows brighter when exposed to direct moonlight or starlight.

### Encounter

The gate puzzle relies on two clues: the Rune code carved on the statue pedestals and the runes engraved across the inner granite arch.

The pedestal grid divides the alphabet into 8 distinct blocks. Each letter on the arch consists of a rune and 1 to 4 dots. The rune indicates the block, and the dots the position of the letter within that block ( `1 dot = 1st letter, 2 dots = 2nd letter, 3 dots = 3rd letter, 4 dots = 4th letter` ).

### Example Breakdown

| Word | Letter | Rune & Dots |
|---|---|---|
| **WE** | W | Rune 9 with 1 dot (1st letter) |
| | E | Rune 3 with 2 dots (2nd letter) |
| **ARE** | A | Rune 2 with 1 dot (1st letter) |
| | R | Rune 7 with 3 dots (3rd letter) |
| | E | Rune 3 with 2 dots (2nd letter) |
| **FRIENDS** | F | Rune 3 with 3 dots (3rd letter) |
| | R | Rune 7 with 3 dots (3rd letter) |
| | I | Rune 4 with 3 dots (3rd letter) |
| | E | Rune 3 with 2 dots (2nd letter) |
| | N | Rune 6 with 2 dots (2nd letter) |
| | D | Rune 3 with 1 dot (1st letter) |
| | S | Rune 7 with 4 dots (4th letter) |

### Puzzle hints

If the players struggle to solve the puzzle, avoid handing them the answer directly. Use ability checks or environmental clues to guide them:

- **Compare runes:** Point out that the runes of the pedestal match the ones across the inner arch.
- **Count the dots:** Highlight that the dots carved above each rune range from 1 to 4, never exceeding 4, matching the maximum of 4 letters in each pedestal block.
- **Scout notes:** Let them find a partial solution from a fallen scout's notes that translates the first two runes, allowing them to use that pattern to find the rest.

Once the players decipher the code, speaking the message aloud activates ancient runic magic that unlocks the door, slowly swinging the adamantine doors inward.

# Act II: Dumrakhal

## The hall of stone trees

This is a 40-by-60-foot grand hall with a 25-foot vaulted ceiling. The only light comes from faint crystals in the high vaulted ceiling, leaving the floor in dim light.

What was once a receiving hall is now swallowed in shadows. Massive pillar trunks carved like ancient oak trees hold up the vaulted ceiling, where clusters of red and yellow crystals mimic pale-glowing autumn leaves.

Curtains of grey silk webs hang between the stone branches, completely covering the hall. Scattered across the floor beneath the webs lie dwarven shields, battleaxes, and spears.

Two side corridors lead away from this room. At the far end, what used to be a big double door is buried under a recent rock collapse. Lying amidst the rubble, a young dwarf girl is unconscious.

### Characteristics

- **Tree pillars:** These pillars were built to welcome people from all around and show Dumrakhal's greatness, but also they are the source of the *Peacekeeper Ward*.

As you approach the tree-like pillars, they almost seem to come to life. High above, the crystals glow softly, releasing a gentle shower of red and gold autumn leaves across the hall.

For a moment, a peaceful illusion fills the room, only to vanish the second the falling leaves touch the heavy grey webs.

- **The webs:** These webs are not made by standard spiders. They are non-sticky, and constructed from an artificial silk.

Touching the grey silk leaves no sticky residue like ordinary spiderwebs. These are not mere strands, but coarse strings, rough and dry, twisted like tough steel wires.

When you pull on one, it offers an unnatural resistance before shrinking to its original position, leaving behind a faint chemical odor.

- **The decoy girl:** Previous scout incursions have warned the Neogi so they have prepared for a future breach. The Neogi use the dwarf girl as a decoy trap to lure intruders into an ambush. As any character approaches the girl, the ambush encounter is triggered.

As you approach the girl, movement flashes in the shadows as figures step out from behind the massive stone tree columns. They are dwarven warriors in light armor, moving with stiff motions and wielding heavy battleaxes. Their eyes are milky white, staring blankly as they charge toward you without uttering a single word.



### Fantastic Details

- **Peacekeeper Ward:** The pillars emit an abjuration aura designed to maintain peace in this room. Any creature inside the hall has disadvantage on attack rolls, and casting a damaging spell requires a successful DC 12 Constitution saving throw, or the spell fails.
- **Welcoming Illusion:** Touching the pillars or casting a light-based spell close to them triggers an illusion spell. The ceiling crystals glow, releasing falling autumn leaves that would cover the floor of the hall if the webs were not there.

### Encounter

This is an ambush encounter with a moral dilemma. The Neogi are attempting to knock intruders unconscious to feed them to their hatchlings. They use a dwarf girl as bait to drag intruders into a trap where mind-controlled dwarves attack. Once the party realizes the attackers are thralls, they must decide: defend themselves or save the dwarves.

- **The Ambush:** Dwarven thralls (Use 1 *Dwarven Warrior* per character) hide behind the stone pillars and attack as soon as a character approaches the girl. Suspicious players who check the columns before approaching can spot the hidden dwarves.
- **The girl's warning:** The combat wakes up the girl, who screams a warning: "Don't kill them! They're not in their right minds!"
- **The Peacekeeper Ward:** The Neogi are unaware of the hall's ward. Because of this, the disadvantage on attack rolls gives the party time to realize what is happening before anyone dies.
- **Bypassing the Ward:** If a player specifies they are attacking with non-lethal force to knock the dwarves unconscious rather than kill them, the Peacekeeper Ward recognizes their peaceful intent and ignores the disadvantage on their attack rolls and the Constitution saving throw when using their spells.
- **Tactics:** The thralls do not speak or negotiate, they fight recklessly. They prioritize spellcasters using fire, as fire poses the greatest threat to Neogi silk. If an enemy is knocked prone, nearby thralls abandon their current targets (even provoking opportunity attacks) to swarm the fallen character.

### Treasure

- **8 Light Shields:** Oak shields reinforced with iron rims, each painted with a dwarven heraldry (4 carried by thralls, 4 abandoned around the hall).
- **9 Battleaxes:** Crafted from dull grey iron, their handles wrapped in dark leather (4 carried by thralls, 5 abandoned around the hall).
- **7 Spears:** Spears capped with thick, triangular iron spearheads (7 abandoned around the hall).

## Star-Iron Forge

This ancient forge uses elemental blue fire to reach extreme heat. This lets smiths work with very hard metals like adamantine or mithral and even imbue gear with magic. However, the forge cannot use its full potential without the Star-Iron Hammer. Because of this, Thrum wants to retrieve the lost hammer more than anything, and he will offer his crafting services and guidance to anyone willing to help him get it back, and gain control from the city again.

***Thrum Heavy-Hand*** is the master blacksmith here and leads the surviving dwarves. He receives the party asking hostile question to check if they are sent by the Neogi, once the party shows they are not thralls Thrum will open the forge doors. He can share valuable information about the invaders, and he may be persuaded to join the party as a guide.

As the double iron door that features a hammer popping out in low-relief opens, the dry and scorching air from this chamber hits you bringing the smell of melted iron with it.

Reinforcing the entrance, a crude barricade made of oak tables, iron bands, and shields tied together with grey chains stands. Spears poke through the gaps, pointing outward, aiming to stop anything trying to break into this forge.

Beyond the barricade, an ancient hexagonal stone hall. To the left, weapon racks, shield pegs, and armor stands. On the right walls, the remaining oak tables hold heavy iron blacksmithing tools, tongs, with big hammers hanging from iron chains. On the opposite wall of the barricade, an archway leading into another room.

At the center of the room, a huge copper dragon head carved into the high ceiling. From its open jaws, a waterfall of blue fire falls straight into the furnace.

Behind the barricade, *Thrum Heavy-Hand* stands side-by-side with four dwarf blacksmiths

## Characteristics

- **The racks:** The party can buy any remaining supplies here. Thrum is grateful for their help, but he will not give away weapons, armor, or tools for free. He firmly believes these goods belong to Dumrakhal, not to him. You can place any gear on these racks at your discretion. In addition to trade, the five dwarf smiths offer their combined blacksmithing services to repair or modify equipment.

Lining the left walls, these weapon racks, shield pegs, and armor stands are almost completely empty. Deep scratches mark the wood and stone where gear was pulled down in a hurry. Only a few scattered items remain hanging. The smiths stripped this armory bare to gear up the resistance, leaving it almost entirely drained.

- **The material deposit:** This room originally held raw metals and crafting supplies, but the smiths have converted it into temporary sleeping quarters since they cannot leave the forge. The raw materials were used to build the barricade and forge gear for the defense. If the party searches this room, they will find no valuable crafting stock left, but at your discretion, they might find small personal trinkets, a hidden stash, or a minor potion tucked inside one of the bedrolls. Resting here is safe as long as the main barricade in Area 2 remains unbroken.

Through the archway lies a cramped room that once stored raw crafting materials. Empty shelves and bins are now pushed against the walls to make room for five improvised bedrolls laid out on the cold floor. A few personal belongings, worn blankets, and small mess kits are scattered around the space, showing where the smiths rest between shifts at the barricade.

- **The furnace:** This is the heart of dwarven pride and economy, a legendary forge built to shape high-quality goods and craft items of mythic power. However, controlling this raw elemental force comes with severe risk.

As you get closer to inspect the furnace, the extreme heat hits your skin.

Looking up, you can see that the copper dragon head on the ceiling is masterfully detailed, built out of hundreds of individually hand-crafted metal scales. A cascade of blue magma pours vertically from its open maw, producing no smoke at all.

Dwarven runes carved along the pillar pulse with a bright blue light. Near the base of the pillar, four heavy iron doors face the cardinal directions, built to let the smiths work directly with the elemental magma.



- Any creature standing within 5 feet of the furnace takes 1d6 fire damage at the start of its turn unless it has fire resistance or the Artisan background.
- If a creature is pushed into the blue magma, it takes 4d10 fire damage immediately and again at the start of each turn it remains in contact with the flow.

### Fantastic Details

- **Elementa fire:** A roaring stream of blue magma flows out from the jaws of the carved copper dragon head on the ceiling. It falls straight down into the furnace like a liquid waterfall, glowing with intense elemental heat while producing no smoke at all.
- **Forge-Fire Refill:** Players can attempt to scoop liquid fire from the open furnace doors to refill or create flasks of Forge-Fire Oil, but if they fail they can get burned by it.
- **Runic Temperature Control:** The furnace temperature can be regulated using the dwarven runes carved along its pillar. However, they cannot be properly controlled without the Star-Iron Hammer.

### Encounter

This is primarily a social encounter with a roleplay interaction where the party uncovers the truth about the Neogi threat and the psychological strain on the dwarven smiths. However, depending on the party's attitude, this encounter could turn hostile. If combat breaks out, use the **Dwarf Warrior** stat block for the smiths; they are exhausted and will surrender before taking lethal damage.

**Dwarf Hostility:** When the party approaches the iron doors, Thrum Heavy-Hand shouts down from behind the barricade. He assumes anyone approaching is sent by the Neogi and demands answers to paranoid questions to verify the party is acting of their own free will.

**The Smiths' Problem:** If the party proves they have free will, Thrum opens the forge doors and welcomes them inside. During the interaction within the forge, the smiths explain that they recently opened a sealed mine shaft to recover the old city's greatness, but spider-like monsters and giant insects poured out from the dark. The smiths used everything they had to supply whoever could fight for the city, but the defenses fell apart quickly. The forge is now completely cut off, running out of food, and missing the Star-Iron Hammer. Thrum mentions that several fallen guards didn't fight back—they simply stopped, dropped their axes, and walked into enemy lines with blank expressions. The dwarves believe this is a dark curse.

**The countdown:** The smiths will run out of food within a week, forcing them into a desperate, fatal last stand against the invaders if nothing changes.

### Treasure

- **2 Flasks of Forge-Fire Oil:** Gifted by Thrum if the party agrees to retrieve the hammer.
- **1 Smithing Set:** A heavy iron toolkit left near the central anvils, including specialized tongs, chisels, and a weighted shaping hammer.
- **5 Personal Dwarf Trinkets:** Worn copper lockets, carved bone dice, and minor dwarven family emblems hidden among the bedrolls in the living quarters.
- **Web-Padding Services:** Thrum can line medium or heavy armor with sound-dampening padding. This modification costs 50 gp in materials (or a favor to the forge) and takes 4 hours. Once applied, the armor no longer imposes disadvantage on Dexterity (Stealth) checks.
- **Equipment Repairs:** Free of charge for allies. The smiths can restore damaged weapons, or repair broken shields.

## The Grotto

This cave is a natural sanctuary isolated from the invaders. Its bioluminescent flora and peaceful atmosphere make it the perfect shelter for survivors to rest and heal.

This beautiful cavern has a completely different vibe from the other rooms. While the rest of the city has been shaped by dwarf hands, this place remains entirely natural. The ceiling is covered in glowing purple moss, and the uneven ground beneath you is covered in a spongy blanket of soft green moss. From the ground bioluminescent mushrooms of all sizes grow, illuminating the cavern with violet, blue, and green colors. The cool air brings the scent of the morning dew and humid soil.

To the east, a 30-foot-tall waterfall feeds a small creek that flows into a tiny stream through the middle of the cave with a soft murmur. To the north, a dense cluster of glowing mushrooms seems to breathe as their bioluminescence pulses. Tiny, glittering particles drift through the air around them. To the west, the soft moss and mushrooms gradually fade as the cavern narrows into a stone passage.



## Characteristics

- **The Shimmering Mushrooms:** The spores from these mushrooms carry a natural substance that provokes hallucinations. Any character who explores this area experiences a peaceful vision of a happy memory from their past. This hallucination has no mechanical effects; it is hereto help the party relax, and share their personal stories.

> As you get closer to the glowing mushroom cluster, you feel a gentle warmth in the air, sweet with the scent of vanilla and warm caramel.
>
> Drifting softly around the fungi, tiny spores float through the dark, blinking like violet, blue, and emerald fireflies. With every breath you take, a feeling of deep peace fills you, inviting you to pause, close your eyes, and let your mind wander.

- **The Moonlit Sanctuary:** Long ago, dwarven worshipers carved a peaceful shrine behind the waterfall dedicated to their moon deity. The special characteristics of this shrine attracted Galgadayle, a gentle Firbolg Cleric who venerates the moon. When the Neogi invaded the city, Galgadayle began sneaking into enemy territory to rescue trapped dwarves from their iron cages. She brings them to this cave to tend their wounds and keep them safe.

> Passing through the mist of the waterfall, the loud sound of falling water softens into a quiet rain. The hidden cave opens into an old shrine. Silver dwarven runes are embedded into the walls
>
> But, what was once a place to connect with God has been turned into a hospital. Hammocks hang between stone pillars, holding a couple injured dwarves who rest beneath improvised bandages.

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## Act III: The final encounter

- What to include: The ultimate confrontation (e.g., Encuentro con el Beholder / Xylaroth).
- Lazy GM Integration: This covers your dedicated Boss Fight / Encounter Preparation.
- Tips: Break this section into three clear sub-headers:
    - The Arena: Interactive lair actions, cover, or environmental hazards.
    - Tactics: How the boss fights intelligently (who they target first, when they try to escape).
    - Resolution: What happens when the boss is defeated, negotiated with, or if the party flees.

# APPENDIX

## Appendix A: Key NPCs and villains

### Thrum Heavy-Hand

*Middle-aged male dwarf*

***Connection to the Adventure*** Thrum is the master blacksmith of the Star-Iron Forge. He knows the city's layout and can warn the party about both the Neogi and their burrowing Umber Hulks. While Neogi avoid the forge, Umber Hulks have attacked the doors before, forcing Thrum to use the city's relic, the Star-Iron Hammer, in battle and losing it in the struggle. He is desperate to recover the hammer and regain control of the city.

> "Quiet down, bird... Ah, travellers. If you can *think for yourselves, prove it. Tell me who you are and why you're here before I let the blue flames roast you."*

Standing before you is a broad-shouldered dwarf holding a heavy sledgehammer. His copper beard is held in place by silver rings, and his left eye is clouded white (from a forge-spark accident years ago). Perched upon his shoulder, a tiny mechanical bird chirps every now and then.

- ***Voice & Mannerisms*** Low and gravelly voice. Speaks to his clockwork bird, Penny, more often than to people.Constantly fidgets with a silver pocket watch.
- ***Secret / Plot Hook*** Needs the party to retrieve the Star-Iron Hammer from the Neogi. In return, he offers specialized gear upgrades: He can modify heavy or medium armor using web-padding, removing disadvantage on Stealth checks caused by that armor.
- ***Notable Items*** Penny is a small copper mechanical bird that chirps when it senses Umber Hulk vibrations (alarming thrum). He has 2 flasks of *Forge-Fire Oil*



# Appendix B: Monsters

## Monsters in the adventure

- Neogi Hatchling (Monsters Of The Multiverse, page 191)
- Neogi (Monsters Of The Multiverse, page 192)
- Neogi Master (Monsters Of The Multiverse, page 192)

## Custom monsters

Simple monster

### Dwarven Warrior

*Medium Humanoid (Dwarf), Lawful Good*

- **Armor Class** 15 (Chain Shirt, Shield)
- **Hit Points** 16 (3d8+3)
- **Speed** 30 ft.

| STR | DEX | CON | INT | WIS | CHA |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 13 (+1) | 11 (+0) | 11 (+0) | 10 (+0) | 11 (+0) | 8 (-1) |

- **Gear** Chain Shirt, Shield, Battleaxe
- **Condition Resistances** Poison
- **Skills** Stealth +6
- **Senses** Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 10
- **Languages** Common, Dwarven
- **Challenge** 1/4 (... XP)

***Dwarven Resilience.*** The Dwarven Warrior has Advantage on any saving throw you make to avoid or end the Poisoned condition.

**Pack Tactics.** The warrior has Advantage on an attack roll against a creature if at least one of the warrior's allies is within 5 feet of the creature and the ally doesn't have the Incapacitated condition.

#### Actions

**Battleaxe.** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 5 (1d8 + 1) slashing damage. If the target is hit, it must succeed on a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or fall prone.

**Battleaxe (Two-Handed).** *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d10 + 1) slashing damage. If the target is hit, it must succeed on a DC 11 Constitution saving throw or fall prone.

# Appendix C: Magic Items & Rewards

## Forge-Fire Oil

*Wondrous Item, Uncommon*

A small flask of azure-blue liquid, crafted from the elemental flames of the forge.

- ***Use.*** As an action, you can apply this oil to one melee weapon or up to 5 pieces of ammunition. For 1 minute, the weapon or ammunition burns with magical blue flames.
- ***Fire Damage.*** Attacks made with the oiled weapon deal an additional 1d6 Fire damage on a hit.
- ***Web Burner.*** Against Neogi silk, webs, or webbed restraints, any hit with an oiled weapon instantly ignites and burns away the webbing without dealing fire damage to trapped creatures.

## Star-Iron Hammer

*Weapon (warhammer), rare*

Forged from the heart of a fallen star, this dwarven warhammer is inscribed with runes that glow with an azure-blue hue.



*— Star-Iron Hammer*

- ***Bonus.*** You gain a +2 bonus to attack and damage rolls made with this magic weapon.
- ***Forge Flare.*** When you hit with this hammer, the weapon bursts with the forge's blue fire, dealing an extra 1d6 fire damage to the target. The blue fire clings to the target, dealing an additional 1d6 fire damage at the start of its next turn.
- ***Celestial Infusion.*** When you use the hammer to craft a magic weapon, armor, or metallic item, the crafting time and gold cost are halved

## Appendix D: Puzzle Handout

- Rune code

| A,B,C | D,E,F | G,H,I | J,K,L |
|---|---|---|---|
| ᚠ | ᛊ | ᛚ | ᚹ |

| M,N,O | P,Q,R,S | T,U,V | W,X,Y,Z |
|---|---|---|---|
| ᚢ | ᛦ | ᚷ | ᚸ |

- WE ARE FRIENDS

ᚸ᛫ ᛊ᛬ ᚠ᛫ ᛦ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᛦ᛬ ᛚ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᚢ᛬ ᛊ᛫ ᛦ⁝

- OPEN FOR FRIENDS CLOSED TO GIANTS

ᚢ᛬ ᛦ᛫ ᛊ᛬ ᚢ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᚢ᛬ ᛦ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᛦ᛬ ᛚ᛬ ᛊ᛬ ᚢ᛬ ᛊ᛫ ᛦ⁝
ᚠ᛬ ᚹ᛬ ᚢ᛬ ᛦ⁝ ᛊ᛬ ᛊ᛫ ᚷ᛫ ᚢ᛬ ᛚ᛫ ᛚ᛬ ᚠ᛫ ᚢ᛬ ᚷ᛫ ᛦ⁝

### Alternative puzzle

Alternative puzzle: Instead of points next to the rune the number of repetitions of each rune indicates the letter from the code.

- WE ARE FRIENDS

ᚸᛊᛊ ᚠᛦᛦᛊᛊ ᛊᛊᛊᛦᛦᛦᛚᛚᛊᛊᚢᚢᛊᛦ

- OPEN FOR FRIENDS CLOSED TO GIANTS

ᚢᚢᚢᛦᛊᛊᚢᚢ ᛊᛊᛊᚢᚢᚢᛦᛦᛦ ᛊᛊᛊᛦᛦᛦᛚᛚᛚᛊᛊᚢᚢᛊᛦᛦᛦ
ᚠᚠᚠᚹᚹᚹᚢᚢᚢᚢᛦᛦᛦᛦᛊᛊᛊ ᚷᚢᚢᚢ ᛚᛚᛚᛚᚠᚢᚢᚷᛦᛦᛦᛦ

# CREDITS

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**Author & Creator:** Sergio Camilo Silva
**Cartography:** Inkarnate & Dungeon Scrawl
**Formatting:** The Homebrewery

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Dumrakhal is an open-choice dungeon crawl. A Neogi colony, led by **Vrax the Silk-Master**, has invaded an ancient dwarven mine through an opened Underdark vein. They have enslaved the dwarven miners and taken control over the main halls. The heroes must enter the infested halls, find allies, free the captive workers, and seal the Underdark breach before the Neogi attack the region.

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